Madhok (who was later expelled from the party) also complained about this kind of pressure. As late as March 1973, he wrote to the then party president, L.K. Advani, complaining that 'the organizing secretaries who happen to be the real power in the Jana Sangh, having been conversant only with the working system of the RSS want to run Jana Sangh on the same lines. They have nothing but, contempt for democratic forms, norms and conventions. Dissent of any kind is anathema for them. They want to suppress all dissidents in the name of discipline. They are interested more in control than in the growth of the party. That is the real problem and dilemma of Jana Sangh which will have to be resolved one day. The sooner it is resolved, the better it would be for the RSS, the Jana Sangh and the country.'[99]

The RSS imprint on the Jan Sangh accrued from its cadre strength. In 1954, the Jan Sangh had only 1,43,000 members. This went up to 2,10,000 by 1959. In contrast, in 1951, the RSS already counted 6,31,500 active members. More significantly, by 1950, while the Jan Sangh had created 2,000 local centres nationwide, the RSS already had 5,000 centres.[100] The RSS held the levers of power.

When Deendayal Upadhyaya took over as party president in 1967, he consolidated the cultural Hindu nationalist underpinning of the party by dividing the party organisation into zones, writes the scholar Pralay Kanungo. Each zone was headed by a former RSS pracharak: Balraj Madhok (North), Nanaji Deshmukh (East), Sundar Singh Bhandari (West), Jagannath Rao Joshi (South). Their work was coordinated by Vajpayee and J.P. Mathur. All these men shared the 'RSS ideology'.[101]

The questions that Sharma and Madhok raised about the RSS would show up again in the problem of 'dual membership' of RSS members that was to plague the Jan Sangh when it merged with the Janata Party in 1977 as part of a grand Opposition alliance to take on the Congress. The Janata government of Morarji Desai fell in 1979 after many of its leaders, including Deputy Prime Minister Chaudhary Charan Singh, questioned the 'dual membership' of former Jan Sangh members.[102]